



WHAT IT COSTS YOU TO SELL YOUR OWN SAUCE

The courier earns more from your bottle than you do.

EHC gets you a big company's shipping, a range a buyer will actually take, and you keep your name on the bottle.

You are the warehouse, the packing bench, the export desk, the sales team and the advertising agency. On an average €8.84 bottle, domestic walk-in postage takes 41–47% of what your customer pays. Across a border, even inside the EU, shipping can cost more than the sauce. **Your customer does not reject your sauce. They abandon the basket.**

And when you stop, the business stops. Take a holiday and you close the shop.

69%

of a Ferment Island order goes to the courier: €20 postage against a €9 bottle, Gozo to Germany

9 of 42

makers we checked showed a delivery price upfront. The rest let the customer find out at checkout

41–47%

of a one-bottle German order is walk-in postage, at €6.19–7.69 on an €8.84 bottle

Five real makers. One bottle each. To Berlin.

MAKER	FROM	BOTTLE	POSTAGE
Eckart Saucen	Berlin	€7.50	€5.50
CZILLI	Austria	€6.00	€10.00
Big Ginger	UK	€9.30	€14.00
Little Red's	Ireland	€9.00	€15.00
MUNNVOLD	Norway	€13.00	€15.50
Total		€44.80	€60.00

Non-euro prices converted and rounded. The couriers earn a third more than all five makers combined.

Today: five separate parcels

Sauce €44.80**Postage €60**

Through one shared hub: one parcel

Same sauces €44.80**€3.99**

That is postage only. Storage and the per-parcel fee are charged separately, and are set out on page 2.

[IMAGE PLACEHOLDER · PACKING BENCH]

One maker, one parcel at a time. This is the job that eats your evenings and 41–47% of the order.



ALREADY RUNNING, BEFORE YOU SIGN ANYTHING

Three things that already sell sauce for makers today.

EHSA

The European Hot Sauce Awards. Independent judging, and a medal a customer trusts and a buyer can defend.

CHILIFEST.EU

Events where people taste your sauce, meet you and buy from you on the day. Three days at capacity, the queue roughly 700 metres.

REPUBLIC OF HEAT

One curated shop that keeps those customers buying all year. It already ships a three-bottle set for about what most makers charge to send one.

One maker's normal month was 50 bottles. After an EHSA coverage wave they sold 400 in five days, and signed a retail contract off the back of it.

One result, not a typical one. It is what recognition plus a route to market did for a maker in your position.

Four things you cannot do at your size. Get a customer's first taste and keep them buying all year. Reach a trade buyer as one range instead of one small supplier. Carry a medal and a mark that buyer can defend upwards. Ship on pooled rates you could never reach on your own volume.

You own every bottle. We never buy your stock.

Your sauce sits in the hub in your name until a customer buys it. Nobody discounts it, dumps it, or decides which of your sauces deserves the space. Your fee pays for the building, never for someone else's stock. The risk also stays where it already is: you paid to make it, and you pay storage while it sits.

What you pay

MEMBERSHIP

[€ per year]

One annual fee. Buys shared buying power, the Maker Mark and the routes to market.

STORAGE

[€ per carton, per month]

You pay for the shelf space you use. Orders go out while you are asleep, at a wedding, or making the next batch.

FULFILMENT

[€ per parcel]

Charged when stock moves. Carriage is passed through at the pooled contract rate, with no mark-up.

Those are the only three charges, and there is no commission on your sales. Every maker who joins after you makes your share of the fixed costs smaller, which is the honest reason to be early rather than eightieth.

NEW, AND IT LANDS ON 12 AUGUST 2026

Every country you sell into now wants its own packaging paperwork.

NO EXEMPTION

The EU Packaging Regulation (2025/40) applies from 12 August 2026. Micro-producers are excused some of it, but not the producer responsibility fees.

COUNTRY BY COUNTRY

You register, report and pay in every member state your bottles reach. Where you are not established, you must appoint an authorised representative there.

AND YOUR BOX

Packaging has to be minimised, and an e-commerce box may be no more than 40% empty space. Penalties run to €200,000.

The fees themselves are small. German registration is free and a small maker's licensing can be under €100 a year. **The cost is the multiplication:** one maker, six countries, six registers, six reports, six sets of rates. Doing that once, for everyone, is exactly what a trade body is for.



THE NEXT 90 DAYS, AND WHAT THEY INVOLVE YOU IN

Two things you can act on now. The warehouse comes after.

30 DAYS

Enter EHSA 2027

The revamped awards launch with visitBerlin. Entries open to independent makers across Europe, with the format, categories, timetable and judging model published up front. You need no warehouse and no freight to enter.

90 DAYS

Take one of the first 80 memberships

The Craft Hot Sauce Maker Mark goes live, with published criteria, governance and permitted claims. You get the written definition of an independent maker first, so you can check whether you qualify before you pay.

Six months: the hub opens and your stock goes in

It opens once enough founding makers have signed to cover its running costs. Until it does, none of your stock is in it, and we will not pretend otherwise.

Why this is worth more than a cheaper postage account: no mainstream grocer in our 25-retailer audit gives hot sauce a shelf of its own. Every incumbent has to buy your stock before it can sell it, which is why most of them never call you. **A category with a name, a definition and a champion behind it is what puts your bottle on that shelf.** Craft beer took four decades and reached 24.7% of US beer dollars. That is a precedent, not a timetable.

Taking one of the 80 places

- 1 Email [**contact address**] and say you want a place.
- 2 We send you the membership terms, the fee, the rates and the Maker Mark criteria, in writing.
- 3 You decide with all of it in front of you. Nothing is due before then.

What we will answer in writing before you pay

- **The numbers:** membership fee, per-carton storage, per-parcel fulfilment, and the minimum stock you need to hold.
- **Where the hub is,** and what it costs to get your first pallet to it from where you are.
- **Whether non-EU makers are eligible,** and who handles the customs entry and VAT position if they are.
- **Whether EHC handles packaging EPR** registration, reporting and authorised representation for members, and what that costs.
- **What happens to your money** if enough makers do not sign and the hub does not open.
- **How you leave:** notice period, and how you get your pallet back.

Every figure here comes from the EHC strategy and is unchanged: the 42-producer checkout test, the 25-retailer category audit and the published market estimates. The full surveys and the accounts are available on request. Republic of Heat is a separate company and EHC's first customer, not EHC itself.

In Ardore Concordia · strength in shared fire